

Health Risk Assessment and Causation

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Chapter Overview

- **Defining Risk:** Understanding risk as the probability of an event occurring, often implying harm.
- **Concepts of Causation:** Reviewing causation from contemporary perspectives.
- **Quantifying Association:** Using ratio and difference to quantify associations.

Chapter Overview

- **Assessing Causal Effect:** Applying attributable risk
- **Competing Risks:** Explaining how competing risks patterns.
- **Risk Perception and Communication:** Recognizing risk perception and communication in public health

① Risks in Population Health

- **Central Task:** Assessing health risks core function
- **Broad Usage of “ Risk ”:** The term describes the **probable outcomes, risk factors, and health consequences**.
- **Risk Factors vs. Risk Markers:** Distinguishing between those that **cause** disease and those that **indicate** its presence.
- **Health Risk Appraisal (HRA):** Using quantitative probabilities for mortality and morbidity risks.
- **Health Risk Assessment:** Evaluating scientific data on **environmental agents** $\Leftrightarrow$ **human exposure**.

② Health Risk Assessment

1. **Hazard Identification:** Identifying harmful substances and describing toxicity.
2. **Dose-Response Assessment:** Modeling exposure and effect size variations.
3. **Exposure Assessment:** Identifying exposed populations, exposure routes, and dose characteristics.
4. **Risk Characterization:** Integrating data to estimate risk likelihood.

② Health Risk Assessment

1. **Hazard Identification:** Identifying harmful
describing toxicity

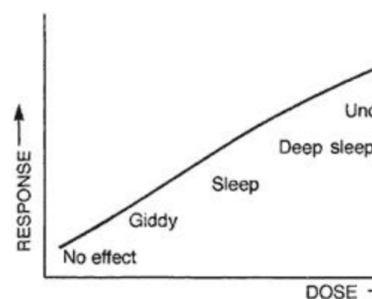
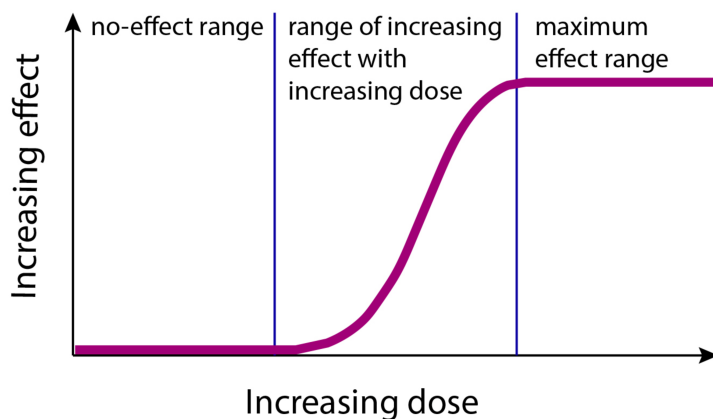


② Health Risk Assessment

- Flint resident lives in uncertainty after lead exposure
- Japan Declares Crisis As Fukushima Reactor Begins To Melt
And Radiation Levels Soar [youtube-link](#)

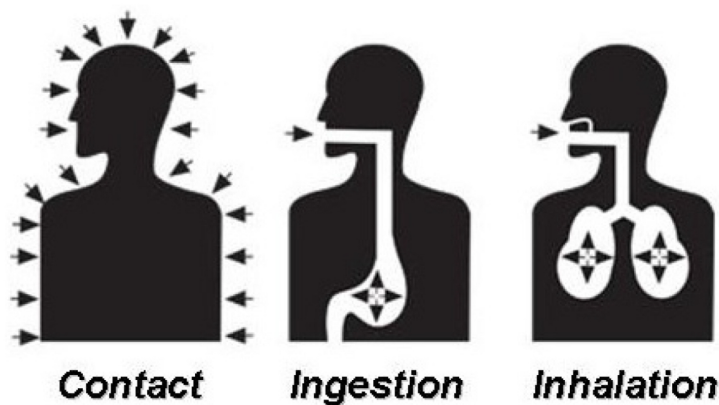
② Health Risk Assessment

2. **Dose-Response Assessment:** Modeling expected effect size variations.



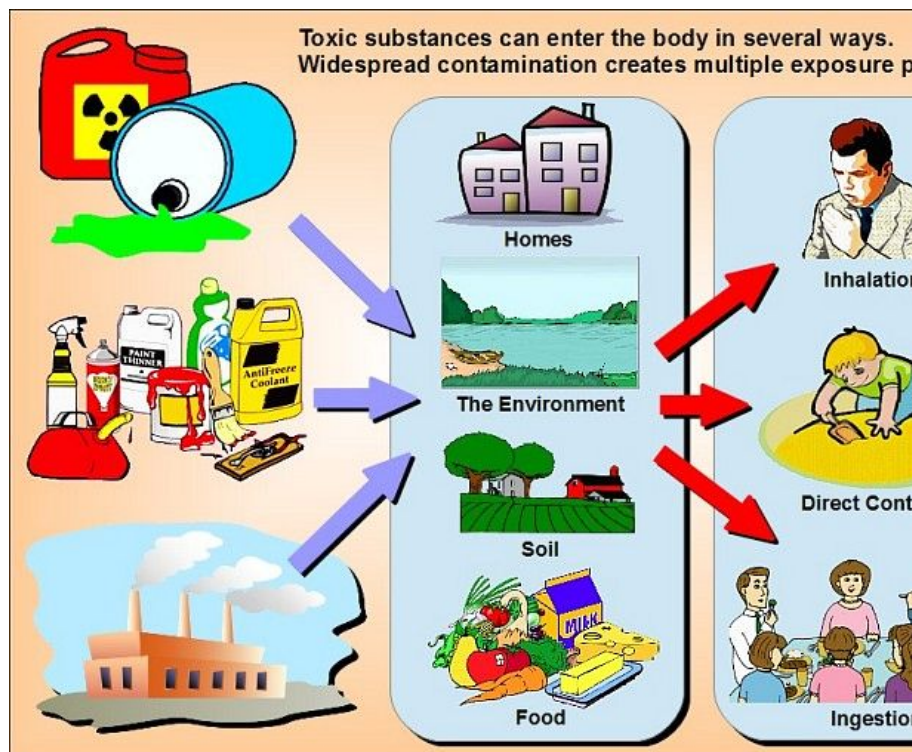
② Health Risk Assessment

3. **Exposure Assessment:** Identifying exposed populations, exposure routes, and dose characteristics.



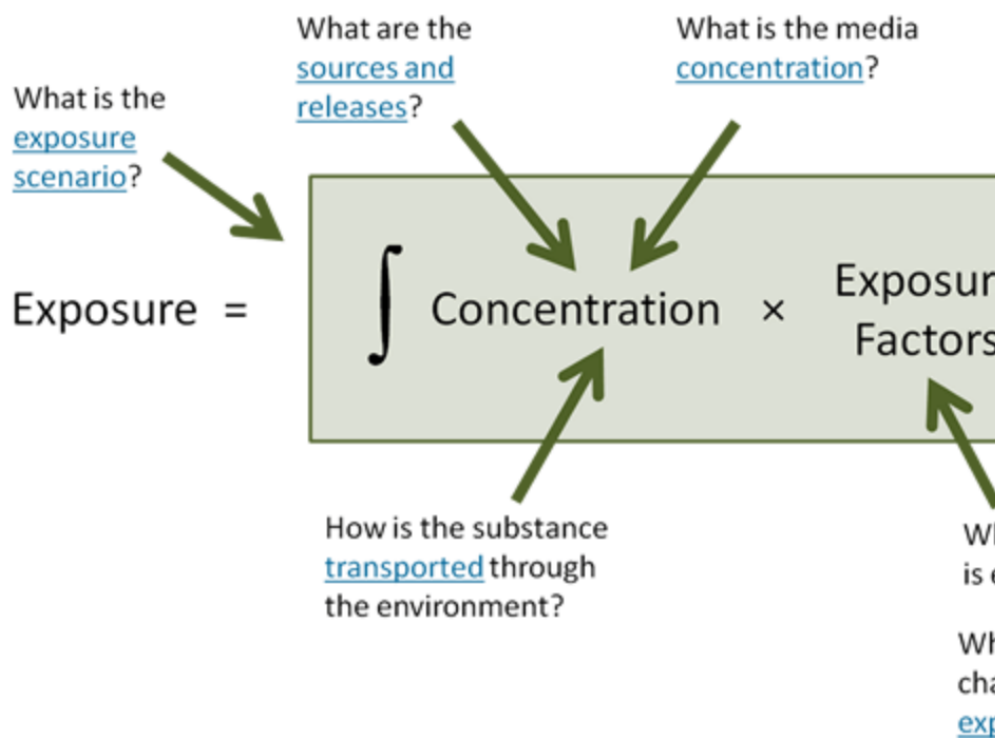
② Health Risk Assessment

3. **Exposure Assessment:** Identifying exposed populations, exposure routes, and dose characteristics.



② Health Risk Assessment

4. **Risk Characterization:** Integrating data to estimate the likelihood.



③ Concepts of Causation

- **Necessary Cause:** A cause that must be present for
- **Sufficient Cause:** A cause that inevitably produces
- **Remote vs. Proximate Causes:** Understanding causality in terms of proximity.

3 Concepts of Causation

- **Bradford Hill's Criteria:**

- 1 **Strength & Consistency** – A strong and repeated association a likelihood of causation.
- 2 **Specificity & Temporality** – The cause should lead to a specific occur **after** the cause.
- 3 **Biological Gradient & Plausibility** – A dose-response relations cause should make biological sense.
- 4 **Coherence & Experiment** – The evidence should align with exi experiments should support the causal link.
- 5 **Analogy**– If similar factors cause similar effects, the associatio

4 Measures of Association

- **Ratio Measures:** Relative risk, risk ratio, rate ratio, c
- **Difference Measures:** Risk difference or attributable
- **Relative Risk (RR):** $RR = \frac{I_1}{I_0}$
- **Odds Ratio (OR):** $OR = \frac{(a/c)}{(b/d)} = \frac{ad}{bc}$
- **Risk Difference (RD):** $RD = I_1 - I_0$
- **Attributable Risk Among the Exposed [AR(E)]:**
$$AR(E) = \frac{(I_1 - I_0)}{I_1} = \frac{(RR - 1)}{RR}$$
- **Population Attributable Risk (PAR):** $PAR = \frac{(I - I_0)}{I}$

5 Competing Risks

- **Definition:** Recognizes that individuals are exposed to multiple risks, where one event prevents another.
- **Importance:** Essential for understanding mortality impact.
- **Statistical Approaches:** Methods to estimate death from competing risks.

⑥ Risk Perception and Communication

- **Subjectivity of Risk:** Public perception differs from
- **Social Construction of Risk:** Influences include social and political factors.
- **Factors Influencing Risk Acceptance:** Fair distribution of alternatives, voluntary vs. imposed risks, and control.
- **Biases in Probability Assessment:** Representativeness and availability.
- **Effective Risk Communication:** Public involvement, honesty, coordination, media engagement, clarity,